

# **Constitution of the Furman University Climbing Club**

2022-2023 Academic School Year

## **Article I: Name of Organization**

The formal name of this organization shall be the Furman University Climbing Club.

## **Article II: Purpose**

The purpose of the Furman University Climbing Club shall be to provide an accessible and open community for those interested in climbing while representing Furman University in the growing Greenville climbing community. We also aim to educate others on the benefits of climbing and to use the organization as not only a means to participate and compete in the sport of climbing, but also as a way to advocate for climbing's accessibility. Accessibility in climbing could mean getting interested members into the gym for the first time, or working with local outdoor climbing organizations to maintain trails and physical accessibility in the mountains.

## **Article III: Affiliations**

Regular practices and group climbs will be held at the BlocHaven climbing gym in Greenville, SC. Additionally, the Furman University Climbing Club will host an indoor climbing team with the USA Climbing (USAC) organization and participate in their national collegiate circuit. The club may also participate in outdoor climbing access volunteering opportunities with the help of the Carolina Climbers Coalition (CCC).

## **Article IV: Membership**

In keeping with Furman University's non-discrimination policies, membership shall be open to all undergraduate, day students. Our organization will not discriminate on the basis of race, sex, handicap, age, sexual orientation, political affiliation, or religious affiliation.

Membership levels are defined in *Article I, section a* of the bylaws, however membership status of any kind may be revoked if actions made by a member are deemed inappropriate or otherwise in defiance of this constitution. Such a dismissal would require a minimum of a  $\frac{1}{2}$  vote of the officers and  $\frac{3}{4}$  vote from the general membership. Once revoked, membership cannot be reclaimed until a minimum of one university semester has passed.

## **Article V: Officers**

*Section I.*

The President(s), Vice President, Secretary, and Treasurer shall make up the Executive Committee of the organization. The Executive Committee shall meet regularly in addition to general club meetings and it is the responsibility of this committee to appoint special committees for any events and responsibilities that may necessitate such a body.

## *Section II.*

Officer elections shall be held once every year to appoint new or reinstate current executives. Any member who has held their membership for at least one year are eligible to be nominated for any officer position baring that of President, for which an existing executive of at least one year must be nominated/reinstated. To elect a standing member of at least one year as an officer, a minimum of a  $\frac{3}{4}$  vote from the general membership body as well as a  $\frac{1}{2}$  vote of officers is required. To elect a standing officer for a different executive role baring that of President, a minimum of a  $\frac{3}{4}$  vote from the general membership body as well as a  $\frac{1}{2}$  vote of officers is required. To elect a standing officer for the role of President, a minimum of a  $\frac{3}{4}$  vote from the general membership body as well as a  $\frac{1}{2}$  vote of current officers is required.

Members who have had membership status revoked at any point in the last calendar year are not eligible for nomination to any executive position.

## *Section III.*

The term of office for an officer position is one year.

## **Article VI: Advisor**

The club advisor is elected solely by the executive committee, requiring a majority vote. The advisor shall not hold any decision-making or voting authority within the organization, however they may offer insight to the executive committee and club members regarding key decisions and actions.

## **Article VII: Meetings**

The Furman University Climbing Club shall meet regularly throughout each academic term baring holidays, summer vacation, or any other times deemed impractical (i.e. exam week). Specific days and times of meeting will be determined at the beginning of each semester by a  $\frac{3}{4}$  vote of the general membership. Not all members are expected to attend every meeting.

### **Article VIII: Finance**

General finances are managed by the club treasurer and all money kept and obtained by the club is to be held in a bank account at a University-approved financial institution. Finances may be obtained through university organizations, membership dues, optional trip fees, and/or merchandise sales.

### **Article IX: Amendments**

Amendments to the constitution must be submitted first to the secretary to be discussed at the next meeting. An amendment must pass by a minimum of  $\frac{3}{4}$  vote from the general membership and  $\frac{1}{2}$  vote from the Executive Committee. Any passed amendments must first be approved by Furman University before they can be ratified.

## **Bylaws of the Furman University Climbing Club**

2022-2023 Academic School Year

### **Article I: Membership**

#### *Section I.*

General Membership - This group is defined as those who express interest in the club by attending club meetings and club-hosted events. There is currently no minimum cutoff defined for qualifying attendance, however if club dues are at any point required for membership, these must be paid in order to hold such a position.

Climbing Team Competitors - This group is defined as members of the club who have also elected to represent the organization at local and regional climbing competitions. The competitions include, but are not limited to, local gym competitions, inter-university competitions, and USAC collegiate circuit events. If funding is available, the club may subsidize competitors for entrance fees and transportation costs associated with attending a competition. In addition to participating in at least two formal climbing competitions each year, Climbing Team Competitors must attend a minimum of 50% of all Climbing Team practices, including workouts, technical training, and/or group climbing sessions.

#### *Section II.*

Regardless of membership type, all active members will be required to have a signed and updated liability waiver to climb at BlocHaven climbing gym.

### **Article II: Selection of Officers**

#### *Section I.*

Officers are elected according to *Article V, Section II*, of the Constitution.

#### *Section II.*

It is the role of the club President(s) to oversee and coordinate the organization's general functioning, as well as to oversee the other members of the executive committee. It is the President(s) duty to uphold these bylaws as well as the organization Constitution in the decisions made by the executive committee.

The Vice President is tasked with overseeing the day-to-day functioning of the club, and acts as an advisor to the President. In the event that there is more than one President in office at a given time, appointing of a Vice President is not required. It is the job of the Secretary to keep and maintain detailed documentation of all organization actions and decisions, as well as to make necessary changes to club documentation when needed. The Secretary is also in charge of maintaining an up to date club membership roster. Finally, it is the role of the Treasurer to manage club finances in accordance with *Article VIII* of the Constitution.

### *Section III.*

In the event of a vacancy of an executive official, a temporary official may be appointed by a  $\frac{1}{2}$  vote of the present executive committee. In the event of a presidential vacancy, either the other president (if present) or vice president will inherent the role of the vacant president until as long as the next election is held.

### *Section IV.*

Removal of any member of the executive committee must first be proposed by any member of the organization and is then to be discussed at the next club meeting. At the end of this meeting, a  $\frac{3}{4}$  vote of present membership as well as a  $\frac{1}{2}$  vote from the executive committee is required to formally remove an officer from their position.

## **Article III: Selection of Advisor**

The organization advisor must be a willing Furman staff/faculty member who shares a general interest in climbing and/or the outdoors. This advisor may be removed by a  $\frac{3}{4}$  vote of the general membership as well as a  $\frac{1}{2}$  vote from the executive committee.

## **Article IV: Committees**

The appointment of special committees outside of the executive committee is outlined in *Article V, Section I*, of the Constitution. These committees may be formed on an as-needed basis by members of the executive committee, and their functions will be outlined in documentation created by the Secretary.

## **Article V: Rules of Order**

Members and executive officers are expected to act in accordance with the Furman University Student Handbook at all times. As representatives of Furman University, it's paramount that all club activities and individual actions are congruent with University values.

Internal disputes should be taken up with a member of the executive committee, who is then responsible for bringing the dispute to the attention of other committee members. Internal conflicts will be addressed after the executive committee has discussed the issue and agreed on an approach. In the case that a Furman University policy has been broken, the conflict will be brought to the attention of the proper university organization.

### **Article VI: Amendments**

Amendments to the bylaws must be submitted first to the secretary to be discussed at the next meeting. An amendment must pass by a minimum of  $\frac{2}{3}$  vote from the general membership and  $\frac{1}{4}$  vote from the Executive Committee. Any passed amendments must first be approved by Furman University before they can be ratified.